

Joseph Wathika Wanini

Backend Software Engineer

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Portfolio • LinkedIn: wathikaww • GitHub: wathika-eng

Professional Summary

Results-driven Backend Software Engineer with 2+ years building scalable APIs, microservices, and secure payment systems. Skilled in Go, TypeScript, Python, and Django with strong REST API development, system testing, and DevOps practices. Extensive experience with Postman, OWASP ZAP, and Burp Suite. Hands-on with Docker, Kubernetes, AWS/GCP, CI/CD pipelines, and database systems. Passionate about secure, maintainable software and delivering reliable backend infrastructure for fintech and DevOps platforms.

Technical Skills

- **Languages:** Go, TypeScript, JavaScript, Python, PHP, SQL, Java
- **Frameworks:** Gin, Echo, Chi, Node.js, Express, Django, DRF, Symfony
- **Frontend:** React, HTML, CSS, Svelte, Vue (basic)
- **Databases:** PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis
- **DevOps:** Docker, Kubernetes, Linux/Unix, VPS, AWS, GCP, Azure (basic)
- **CI/CD:** GitHub Actions, GitLab CI, Jenkins (basic)
- **Monitoring:** Prometheus, Grafana
- **APIs:** REST, GraphQL, gRPC, OpenAPI/Swagger, API Gateway
- **Security:** OWASP ZAP, Burp Suite, PCI DSS, JWT, OAuth2, API Pentesting
- **Soft Skills:** Agile/Scrum, Collaboration, Documentation, Problem-Solving

Professional Experience

County Government of Kiambu (Filtronic International), Nairobi, Kenya *Sep 2023 – Present*
System Tester, Technical Support & QA Analyst (Hybrid)

- Managed technical support operations for mission-critical ERP systems serving public finance and service delivery
- Performed manual QA, REST API testing, and security testing using Postman, OWASP ZAP, and Burp Suite
- Identified critical vulnerabilities improving application security posture by 40%
- Validated backend data using SQL (PostgreSQL/MySQL) ensuring data integrity and compliance with PFMA
- Logged and tracked 200+ bugs in Jira with 95% resolution rate
- Created detailed test plans and test cases, reducing production bugs by 30%
- Participated in Agile sprints, contributing to 20% improvement in QA-Dev collaboration
- Supported UAT and translated legal/functional requirements into test scenarios

Education

Jomo Kenyatta University of Agriculture and Technology, Nairobi *Sep 2020 – Dec 2023*
Bachelor of Science

Moringa School, Nairobi *Feb 2024 – Nov 2024*
Certificate in Software Engineering — *Grade: A*

- Built production-ready systems using Go, TypeScript, React, Django
- Developed secure REST APIs with auth and database integration
- Implemented CI/CD pipelines using GitHub Actions

Certifications & Training

- **Certified Ethical Hacker (CEH)** — CyberShujaa *Sep 2025 – Present*
- **API Penetration Tester** — API Sec University (Ambassador) *Jun 2025 – Present*
- **Devolved Governance Systems** — KIPPR *May 2024*

- **CompTIA A+ — JKUAT**

Jul 2021

Professional Activities & Leadership

API Sec University — Remote

Jul 2025 – Present

API Sec University Ambassador

- Conduct workshops on secure API design and vulnerability assessment
- Advocate for API security best practices in developer communities

Jomo Kenyatta University of Agriculture & Tech

Sep 2020 – Dec 2023

Class Representative

- Liaison between students and faculty; represented class in departmental meetings

Languages

English: Professional • **Swahili:** Native

References

Available upon request.